

Twins

Just a few weeks to go. By now, you're probably quite large and, of course, excited at the imminent arrival of your twins, or more. However, you may also be concerned about how you will manage during and after the birth.

Getting ready for the birth

Although multiple pregnancies and births are more likely to have complications, they are now safer than ever as advances in prenatal and postpartum care have dramatically improved the outlook for premature babies—the main concern with multiples (see below).

You can prepare for the birth by getting plenty of rest. Putting your feet up, or even taking a nap during the day, helps improve the blood flow to the placenta, which in turn helps your babies grow. Practicing [Kegel exercises](#) is important with a multiple pregnancy since your pelvic floor muscles are under additional strain.

A shorter pregnancy Twins or more usually arrive earlier than singletons. Space in the uterus is one factor. As a result, the average length of pregnancy is shorter; for twins, 36–37 weeks is considered typical; for triplets, the average pregnancy is 33 weeks; and for quadruplets, pregnancy lasts about 30 weeks. The average birth weight for each twin is 5 lb 8 oz (2.5 kg) at full term.

You may deliver even earlier than this, since nearly 50 percent of twins are born prematurely. However, nowadays expert care for premature babies means that about 75 percent of babies weighing 3 lb 5 oz at birth, and 57 percent of babies weighing 2 lb 3 oz at birth, survive.

BONDING WITH TWINS

Often, expectant moms of twins or more worry about how they will bond with more than one baby. It's true that bonding can be harder with twins, and even more so with higher multiples. After all, it's hard to fall in love with more than one person at a time, especially when you're exhausted caring for two babies or more. Being aware of this and arranging extra help for after the birth may ease your anxiety. Also, accept additional offers of help that allow you to rest or spend time with one twin. If someone offers to take the twins out, you might consider one twin going and the other spending time with you.

Even if your twins are identical they're unique individuals, and relating to them as such will help their development and your relationship with them. Even in pregnancy, some expectant moms notice how different their babies are from their different movement patterns in the womb.